

MINUTES OF PROCEEDINGS AT MONTHLY MEETING OF THE MUNICIPAL DISTRICT OF ADARE-RATHKEALE HELD IN ÁRAS SEÁN FINN, NEW LINE ROAD, RATHKEALE, CO. LIMERICK ON TUESDAY, 14TH JANUARY, 2025 AT 9.30 A.M.

PRESENT IN THE CHAIR:

Councillor A. Teskey, An Cathaoirleach.

MEMBERS PRESENT:

Councillors Collins, Hartigan, Keary, O'Donoghue and Ward.

OFFICIALS IN ATTENDANCE:

Director, Rural, Community, Culture and Tourism Development (Mr. S. Duclot), Meetings Administrator (Ms. K. Butler), Senior Executive Engineer, Roads, Traffic and Cleansing (Mr. G. O'Connor), Executive Engineer, Roads, Traffic and Cleansing (Mr. J. O'Keeffe), Clerical Officer (Ms. L. Lenihan).

At the outset of the Meeting Councillor Collins thanked Ger O'Connor, Senior Executive Engineer and John O'Keefe, Executive Engineer, Roads, Traffic and Cleaning, as well as all the outdoor staff of the Adare-Rathkeale Municipal District for all their efforts in keeping roads clear during the recent adverse weather. Councillor Teskey also thanked Roads Supervisors John Coleman and Noel O'Connor along with the Director General and District Executive staff and requested Elected Members gratitude be extended to all.

1. Adoption of Minutes

Circulated, copy of draft Minutes of the Monthly Meeting of the Municipal District of Adare-Rathkeale held on 10th December, 2024.

Proposed by Councillor Collins;

Seconded by Councillor Keary;

And Resolved:

"That the draft Minutes, as circulated, be taken as read, adopted and signed".

Councillor Teskey raised the issue of costs associated with the preparation of a Traffic Management survey for Adare and both he and Councillor O'Donoghue were of the opinion that no work should be carried out on a Traffic Management survey until the Adare bypass is complete.

Discussion ensued, Councillor Collins stated she had requested a copy of the Adare Traffic Management Plan at the December District Meeting, which to date had not been furnished to Members, and again requested this matter be followed up by the Meetings Administrator.

2. Declaration of Interest

The Meetings Administrator stated that, in line with Part 15 of the Local Government Act, 2001, as amended, and the Code of Conduct, she was inviting those present to notify the Cathaoirleach of any declaration of interest in any item due for discussion at the Meeting.

No such interest was declared.

3. Roads, Traffic and Cleansing

District Engineers Report

Circulated, report of the Senior Executive Engineer, Roads, Traffic and Cleansing dated 14th December, 2024 outlining details of proposed works, projects and future projects planned for the District.

The following issues were raised by Members:

- Councillor O'Donoghue asked if additional roads maintenance funding has been allocated due to the impact from the recent adverse weather events. The Senior Executive Engineer, advised the Roads, Traffic and Cleansing Department are currently assessing the level of damage caused to roads and will be preparing an application for additional funding to the Department in due course, however, he cautioned there was no guarantee approval would be received for same.
- Councillor Keary requested the closing time of the Rathkeale Greenway carpark be extended. It was agreed this matter would be referred to Ben Noonan, Senior Executive Engineer, Tourism Department for his direct response.

4. General Municipal Allocation (GMA)

On the proposal of Councillor Teskey, seconded by Councillor Ward, it was agreed to allocate the following:

- €2,000 to Askeaton Civic Trust.
- €8,000 to KAC Residents Association.

On the proposal of Councillor Ward, seconded by Councillor Teskey, it was agreed to allocate €2,000 to Askeaton Civic Trust.

QUESTIONS

5. Question submitted by Councillor A. Teskey

I will ask at the next Meeting given the fact that the proposed works to the Adare Heritage Centre have gone on display on E tenders can the Council confirm if it has

monies sanctioned for the proposed project if so how much is allocated and from what budget has the allowance been made available from.

Reply: This is a call for **expression of interest** for the proposed development from suitably qualified contractors. It was advertised in the Official Journal of the EU on the 13th of December 2024.

Candidates will be assessed for suitability and successful applicants will be shortlisted for inclusion on a tender panel to be used should the project progress to tender stage in the future if funding is secured.

6. Question submitted by Councillor A. Teskey

I will ask at the next Meeting how many planning applications were appealed to An Bord Pleanála both by the Local Authority and the proposed applicant in 2024. How many of these were overturned by the Bord and what percentage does this represent overall.

Reply: In 2024, 88 no. appeals were made to An Bord Pleanála in respect of decisions made by Limerick City and County Council. 41 appeals were made by the first party (applicant) and the remainder were third party appeals.

Of the decisions made to date on 2024 appeals made to An Bord Pleanála, 2 No. decisions have been overturned.

NOTICE OF MOTION

7. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor J. O'Donoghue

I will move at the next Meeting that we write to the Department of Housing, Local Government and Heritage and any other relevant Government Departments to change the regulations on the newest application forms for Housing Adaptation Grants for older people and disabled people. Most notably the unavailability of a grant to replace a fossil fuel burner if the current burner is unrepairable.

The Motion was proposed by Councillor O'Donoghue, seconded by Councillor Teskey and agreed to forward for inclusion on the Agenda for the next Full Council Meeting.

In proposing the Motion Councillor O'Donoghue stated older house stock units are not suitable for air to water installation and there will be huge cost burdens on home owners as well as the Local Authority when they retrofit their social housing stock. He further added following the recent electricity outages due to adverse weather conditions these properties would not have heating or cooking facilities with air to water installation. Councillor Teskey added there also is an extra burden on people with medial conditions who are reliant on electricity and added the Housing Adaptation Grant

scheme should be amended to include funding to purchase of generator for private properties.

8. A.O.B

- Councillor O'Donoghue requested a presentation on the dereliction process and also an update on the Adare-Rathkeale Municipal District derelictions sites.
- Councillor Teskey requested Askeaton Pool and Leisure and Ballywilliam Estate in Rathkeale be items on the Agenda for discussion at the February Municipal District Meeting. He further requested an update on the unfinished footpath from Kildimo Village to the Beer Garden Public House.
- Councillor Keary requested a Special Meeting be convened to discuss the proposed social housing scheme for Adare including an update on the serviced sites and storm water issues.
- Councillor Keary requested an update on the Bank of Ireland Building in Rathkeale and also an update on the new Approved Housing Body scheme in Pallaskenry and expressed his frustration on the delays on this project.

This concluded the Meeting.

Signed:

Cathaoirleach

Dated:
